# Craig Togarepi

## Content Writer & Researcher

Clear, accurate writing on news, faith and technology.

**WRITING PORTFOLIO**

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ABOUT

# Software developer turned content writer

I am based in Harare, Zimbabwe. Working as a front-end and back-end developer taught me to research carefully, explain complex ideas in plain language, and check my work before it ships. I now apply the same discipline to writing for readers. I hold the ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity credential, plus development certificates from FreeCodeCamp and Uncommon.org.

## What I write

- US and UK news explainers that lead with the key point and stay neutral
- Faith-based reflections written with care and respect for the reader
- Plain-English explainers on technology, AI and cybersecurity

## How I work

- **Research first.** At least two credible sources per claim, with primary sources preferred.
- **Verify.** Names, dates and numbers are checked before anything is published.
- **AI as an assistant, not the author.** I use AI tools for research leads, outlines and first drafts, then fact-check and rewrite every line.
- **Edit hard.** Every piece is reviewed for accuracy, clarity, grammar and consistency.
- **Fit the audience.** Tone and structure change with the reader and the format.

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The samples below are written to show range and process. News figures are as reported by the cited sources on 27 October 2026.

US NEWS EXPLAINER

# US Midterms 2026: What Is at Stake

Written 27 October 2026 | about 300 words

On Tuesday 3 November, Americans vote in midterm elections that will decide who controls Congress for the rest of President Donald Trump's term. The result will shape what he can pass, block and face scrutiny over in his final two years.

## The numbers that matter

Republicans currently hold a 218–214 majority in the House, with two vacancies, and a 53–47 majority in the Senate. Democrats need a net gain of four seats in each chamber to take control. Ten Senate races, including contests in Maine, Ohio, North Carolina, Iowa and Georgia, could decide the outcome.

It is not only about Congress. Thirty-nine states are choosing governors, and nearly every state is electing legislators. Each of the 50 states runs its own election, so rules differ, and early voting has been under way for weeks.

## What voters care about

Rising prices dominate the debate, from healthcare and groceries to housing and energy. Immigration enforcement is another flashpoint, and fuel prices have been linked to the US war against Iran. President Trump's approval stood at 32 per cent in a September Reuters/Ipsos poll, described as an all-time low.

## The money and the turnout

A record $3.8 billion in political advertising had aired by 12 October. If turnout matches 2022, more than 100 million people will vote; more than 155 million ballots were cast in 2024.

## What to watch on the night

Results arrive state by state, and close races can take days to call. Keep an eye on the handful of Senate states named above and on the narrow House margin. A net swing of four seats is what Democrats need in either chamber.

**Sources**

Khaleej Times: US midterm elections 2026, all you need to know ahead of November 3

UK NEWS EXPLAINER

# Autumn Budget 2026: What to Watch as Healey Delivers His First

Written 27 October 2026 | about 330 words

Tomorrow, Wednesday 28 October, Chancellor John Healey delivers his first Budget, and the first under Prime Minister Andy Burnham. It is the clearest signal yet of how the new government will turn its promises into tax and spending decisions.

## The squeeze on the numbers

Healey has said the Budget will meet the government's fiscal rules, the limits it sets itself on borrowing and debt. But estimates suggest more than half of the headroom against those rules has gone since March, partly because of the fallout from the Iran war. That raises the prospect of tax rises. The Office for Budget Responsibility publishes its updated economic and fiscal outlook on the same day.

## Income tax thresholds

The personal allowance and other thresholds are frozen until April 2031, which draws more people into paying tax as wages rise. The Prime Minister has said there is no commitment to change this but that it will be looked at in the Budget. Moving away from the freeze would be costly.

## Household bills

A temporary cut to VAT on domestic electricity is expected to take about £45 off the annual Ofgem price cap. It is time-limited, and it is unclear whether it will run beyond March 2027.

## Pensions and devolution

Rachel Reeves earlier pledged that people receiving only the basic or new State Pension would not get small tax bills through Simple Assessment from April 2027, though the detail is still awaited. Separately, the government says mayors will keep a greater share of locally raised revenue, starting with business rates.

## What to watch

Three answers will set the tone for the government's first year: whether the threshold freeze changes, whether taxes rise elsewhere, and what the OBR forecasts for growth.

**Sources**

Cambridge Network: Healey sets a pre-Halloween Autumn Budget

RBS: Autumn Budget 2026, the key dates

FAITH-BASED REFLECTION

# Hope That Waits

A short devotional | about 230 words

Waiting is one of the hardest things faith asks of us. We pray, and the answer does not come by Friday. We plan, and the door stays shut. In those seasons it is tempting to read silence as absence.

The writers of the Bible knew this feeling well. The Psalms are full of people asking how long they must wait, and many of those poems end with a quiet decision to hope anyway. The pattern is worth noticing: honesty first, trust second. Faith does not pretend the wait is easy.

The book of Proverbs gives a simple instruction: trust God with all your heart instead of leaning on your own understanding, and he will make your paths straight. It does not promise speed. It promises direction.

Waiting well often looks ordinary. It might mean doing today's work faithfully while the larger answer is still unclear, keeping a promise when nobody is watching, or sitting with a friend who is waiting too. These small acts are not a pause in the story. They are part of it.

If you are in a season of waiting today, you are not forgotten and you are not behind. Take the next faithful step, and let tomorrow carry its own worries.

## A short prayer

> *Lord, give me patience for what is slow, courage for what is next, and trust for what I cannot see. Amen.*

TECHNOLOGY EXPLAINER

# How AI Chatbots Work, and Why You Still Need to Check Them

Written for a general audience | about 290 words

AI chatbots such as ChatGPT and Claude can draft an email, summarise a report or explain a tricky idea in seconds. They feel like a knowledgeable assistant. It is more accurate to think of them as very fast pattern-matchers.

## What is happening underneath

These tools are built on large language models, systems trained on huge amounts of text. During training, the model learns which words and ideas tend to follow one another. When you ask a question, it builds an answer one small piece at a time, choosing what is likely to come next given your question and what it has already written.

## Why they sometimes get things wrong

Because the model predicts plausible text rather than looking up verified facts, it can produce an answer that sounds confident and is simply wrong. This is often called a hallucination. Common examples include invented statistics, quotes and web links. A model can also be out of date if it cannot search the web.

## How to use them well

Use AI for what it does best: brainstorming, outlines, first drafts and simplifying hard material. Then treat every factual claim as unverified until you confirm it with a primary source such as an official website, a published study or a reputable news organisation. Check names, dates and numbers first, and rewrite the result in your own voice.

## The bottom line

AI is a powerful assistant and a poor editor-in-chief. The writer still owns the accuracy, and that human check is what earns the reader's trust.